

ITC C103
WW2 - M3U1 Midterms Assignment 8

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Answers and Questions:

1. When building a new desktop computer or upgrading an old one, what is the single most important component that determines the range of parts you can use for upgrades in the future?

Answer: The motherboard. Its CPU socket type and chipset determine which processors, RAM type/capacity, and expansion cards you can use.

2. You need to choose a new device to store all your school projects, photos, and personal documents long-term. What type of computer component provides persistent storage, and what are two common examples of it?

Answer: Secondary (non-volatile) storage. Two common examples: a hard disk drive (HDD) and a solid-state drive (SSD). USB flash drives and cloud storage also work as long-term options.

3. A friend wants to know how fast their new computer's CPU is. How is a CPU's speed measured, and what is the function of a heatsink in keeping the CPU from overheating?

Answer : Speed is measured in gigahertz (GHz), by clock cycles per second. A heatsink absorbs heat from the CPU and spreads it across its metal fins (usually copper or aluminum) so the heat dissipates into the air, often assisted by a fan. Thermal paste between the CPU and heatsink improves heat transfer.

4. You want to add a powerful graphics card to your desktop computer for gaming. What type of expansion slot should you look for on the motherboard to ensure the fastest connection?

Answer : PCI Express (PCIe) x16 slot. It offers the fastest connection for graphics cards.

5. You need to change a core setting on your computer, such as the boot order or system clock, before the operating system even loads. What is the name of the program you would access to do this, and how do you typically get to it when you first turn on the computer?

Answer : BIOS/UEFI (the firmware setup utility). You get to it by pressing a specific key during startup, before the OS loads. Common keys are Del, F2, F10, or Esc, depending on the motherboard or manufacturer.